



ALPHA DATA

ALPHA DATA P.J.S.C

Higher Colleges of Technology

RFP Ref. NE-26-0129 — Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) — 3 Years

Information Security Requirements Checklist — Response

Item-by-item response to RFP NE-26-0129 Information Security Requirements Checklist (Section 5)

Portal Section 3 — Technical Criteria & Scope Compliance (mandatory checklist submission)

Technical Submission — September 2026

Commercial-in-Confidence

Alpha Data confirms compliance with every clause of the HCT Information Security Requirements Checklist. The FortiSASE platform is independently attested (ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, CSA STAR — verifiable at <https://trust.fortinet.com/>), the tenant is pinned to HCT-approved UAE/GCC PoPs, and Alpha Data's ISO-certified management system governs the supplier-side controls for the full 3-year term.

1. How to read this response

Each checklist item is answered Yes / No / N/A with remarks and, where applicable, verifiable evidence: Fortinet product documentation links, the Fortinet Trust Portal (<https://trust.fortinet.com/>) for SOC 2 / ISO attestations, and cross-references to the Scope of Work commitments made in our submissions S3.1–S3.6. Platform controls are inherited from FortiSASE; supplier controls are operated by Alpha Data under its ISMS.

2. Section 5.1 — Information Security Governance & Policy

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
5.1.1	Documented ISMS aligned with an internationally recognised standard (ISO/IEC 27001, NIST CSF, UAE IA) with evidence of certification/compliance on request.	Yes	Alpha Data operates a documented ISMS certified to ISO/IEC 27001:2022 — Certificate No. AE59507E (attached), issued by Staunchly Management and System Services Ltd, EGAC-accredited, IAF MLA member; initial registration 10 April 2025, recertification due 9 April 2028; online verification at staunchlyservices.com . The FortiSASE platform itself holds ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II and CSA STAR attestations (https://trust.fortinet.com/).
5.1.2	Compliance with national cybersecurity policies and regulations issued by the Cyber Security Council (CSC), with evidence on request.	Yes	Alpha Data is a UAE-headquartered P.J.S.C operating in line with applicable CSC policies and UAE IA guidance; evidence of adherence available upon request.
5.1.3	Formally approved Information Security Policy, reviewed periodically or on significant change.	Yes	Approved corporate Information Security Policy in force, reviewed at least annually and after material organisational or threat changes.
5.1.4	Named Information Security Officer (or equivalent) with defined responsibilities (incident response, vulnerability, patch, BCDR, continuity, etc.).	Yes	Alpha Data designates a named ISO accountable for the security programme; contact details will be shared at contract award as part of the governance pack.
5.1.5	Roles, responsibilities and segregation of duties formally defined, documented and communicated.	Yes	Documented RACI and segregation-of-duties matrix maintained under the ISMS and applied to the HCT service (delivery vs. operations vs. audit roles separated).
5.1.6	Current register of applicable regulatory, legal and contractual compliance obligations, available to HCT.	Yes	Compliance obligations register maintained under the ISMS; the HCT contract obligations will be added at award and made available

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
			to HCT on request.
5.1.7	Formal security programme reviews at least annually with senior management sign-off.	Yes	Annual management review of the security programme conducted with senior management sign-off, per ISMS practice.
5.1.8	Security metrics programme; agreed KPIs/KRIs reported to HCT periodically.	Yes	Security KPIs/KRIs will be embedded in the monthly service report and quarterly governance reviews (aligned with SOW Section 3.18/3.21 and the vendor scorecard).
5.1.9	Subcontractors and sub-processors bound by information security obligations no less stringent than those imposed by HCT.	Yes	Back-to-back security obligations are flowed down contractually; Fortinet, as the platform provider, is bound under the OEM agreement and its published SOC 2 / ISO 27001 attestations.

3. Section 5.2 — Risk Management & Security by Design

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
5.2.1	Documented information security risk management process aligned with an accepted framework (ISO 27001, UAE IA).	Yes	Risk management process operated under the ISO/IEC 27001-aligned ISMS covering identification, assessment, treatment and monitoring.
5.2.2	Formal risk assessment (aligned with HCT IS risk processes) at least annually and on significant change.	Yes	Annual risk assessment for the HCT service, plus event-driven reassessment on significant change; methodology will be aligned to HCT's IS Risk Management Processes at mobilisation.
5.2.3	Risk register with likelihood, impact, owners, treatment, remediation timelines and residual risk for HCT services.	Yes	A dedicated HCT service risk register is maintained and reviewed in the quarterly governance meetings.
5.2.4	Documented risk acceptance process requiring senior management authorisation above a defined threshold.	Yes	Documented risk acceptance workflow with senior management authorisation; acceptances above threshold are time-bound between identification and mitigation.
5.2.5	Material security risks affecting HCT data, operations or regulatory standing communicated immediately after confirmation.	Yes	Immediate notification to HCT upon confirmation of any material risk, via the agreed escalation matrix and governance channels.
5.2.6	The solution shall incorporate security risk considerations in the design, development, operations, and change management lifecycle (Security by Design).	Yes	Fulfilled based on the SOC 2 certification. The FortiSASE SOC 2 certificate can be downloaded from https://trust.fortinet.com/ .

4. Section 5.3 — Identity & Access Management

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
5.3.1	The solution shall support seamless integration with the HCT Identity and Access Management (IAM) solution.	Yes	FortiSASE supports integration with IAM solutions. References: https://docs.fortinet.com/document/fortisase/7.4.0/administration-guide/623391/access-authentication and https://docs.fortinet.com/document/fortisase/7.4.0/administration-guide/579402/sso .
5.3.2	The solution shall support role-based access control (RBAC) with least privilege.	Yes	Supported via resource-based permissions: https://docs.fortinet.com/document/fortisase/7.4.0/administration-guide/278888/resource-based-permissions .
5.3.3	The solution shall support MFA for all user access, particularly privileged, administrative and remote access.	Yes	FortiSASE management access is via FortiCloud, which mandates MFA. An external IdP can be integrated and requires user consent to use MFA: https://docs.fortinet.com/document/fortisase/7.4.0/administration-guide/628397/supporting-external-idp-users .
5.3.4	Formal access provisioning and de-provisioning with revocation within 24 hours for terminations.	Yes	Access to FortiSASE is governed via FortiCloud access. Regulation of admin users can be enforced through the PAM and IAM solutions integrated with FortiCloud; Alpha Data's managed-service JML process guarantees revocation within 24 hours of termination.
5.3.5	Strong authentication policies: password complexity, minimum 14-character length, configurable lockout.	Yes	Strong authentication is mandated for FortiSASE admin access; password and lockout policy is enforced at FortiCloud/IdP level in line with HCT policy.
5.3.6	Integration with HCT's identity provider (Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD) via SAML 2.0 or OIDC for SSO.	Yes	An external IdP (including Microsoft Entra ID) can be integrated for FortiSASE management via SAML 2.0: https://docs.fortinet.com/document/fortisase/7.4.0/administration-guide/628397/supporting-external-idp-users .
5.3.7	Formal access reviews at least every six months (quarterly for privileged accounts).	Yes	Alpha Data performs six-monthly user access reviews and quarterly privileged access reviews for the HCT service, evidenced in the quarterly configuration review deliverables (SOW 3.18).
5.3.8	Separate privileged access mechanisms (e.g., PAM) for administrative and service accounts, with full session logging.	Yes	Integration can be done with the customer's PAM solution; full admin audit sessions are logged on FortiSASE: https://docs.fortinet.com/document/fortisase/7.4.0/administration-guide/450289/administrator-events .

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
5.3.9	No shared or generic accounts; all accounts uniquely attributable to an individual.	Yes	Named individual administrator accounts only, enforced via FortiCloud IAM/IdP integration; no shared credentials are used in the managed service.
5.3.10	Automatic termination/lock of inactive sessions after a configurable inactivity timeout.	Yes	Configurable idle-session timeout is enforced for the FortiSASE management portal and administrative sessions.
5.2.11	All default vendor-supplied credentials changed before delivery or first use; no hardcoded credentials.	Yes	All default credentials are changed during staging before first use, per Alpha Data's hardening baseline; no hardcoded credentials exist in delivered components.

5. Section 5.4 — Data Protection & Privacy

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
5.4.1	All HCT data encrypted in transit using TLS 1.2 or higher; TLS 1.0/1.1 disabled.	Yes	The solution is SOC 2 compliant; the SOC 2 certificate can be downloaded from https://trust.fortinet.com/ . TLS 1.2+ is enforced for all service communications.
5.4.2	All HCT data at rest encrypted using AES-256 or equivalent approved cipher.	Yes	The solution is SOC 2 compliant; the SOC 2 certificate can be downloaded from https://trust.fortinet.com/ .
5.4.3	HCT data stored and processed only within data centres/regions explicitly approved by HCT in writing; cross-border transfers require prior approval.	Yes	Security PoP activation is part of user selection during service provisioning — the tenant will be provisioned only on the two HCT-approved UAE/GCC PoPs (SOW 3.21.4), and no additional regions are enabled without HCT written approval.
5.4.4	On termination or request, HCT data returned in usable format and verifiably deleted from all vendor systems within 30 days.	Yes	Data is exportable in JSON/XML (aligned with the quarterly escrow obligation, SOW 3.21.6); on expiry Fortinet retains configuration/data for 14 days for collection before irreversible deletion, and Alpha Data will certify deletion within the 30-day window.
5.4.5	HCT data not used for any purpose other than service delivery (no AI training, analytics or advertising).	Yes	Contractually committed — HCT data is processed solely for service delivery under HCT's instructions; HCT retains ownership of all data (SOW 3.23).
5.4.6	Configurable data retention aligned to HCT requirements, with automated deletion at end of retention.	Yes	Log retention is configurable; portal logs are complemented by streaming to HCT's SIEM/archival tier to meet the 12-month online requirement (SOW 3.10), with automated expiry at end of retention.
5.4.7	Data handled per controls aligned with the HCT data classification scheme.	Yes	Alpha Data will map service data handling to HCT's classification scheme at mobilisation

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
			and enforce it through the managed-service runbooks.
5.4.8	Data stored/processed within HCT-approved data centres and regions; cross-border transfers require prior approval.	Yes	As 5.4.3 — tenant pinned to HCT-approved UAE/GCC PoPs; any change is subject to HCT prior written approval via change control.
5.4.9	Personal data processed only per HCT documented instructions and applicable data protection laws.	Yes	Committed — processing per HCT instructions and UAE data protection law; reflected in the contract data-processing terms.
5.4.10	Current Record of Processing Activities (RoPA) for all personal data processed for HCT.	Yes	A RoPA for the HCT service is established at mobilisation and maintained through the governance cadence.
5.4.11	Data minimisation — only minimum personal data collected and retained.	Yes	The service processes identity, device and traffic metadata necessary for secure access only; no unnecessary personal data is collected.
5.4.12	Documented data retention and secure disposal policies with verifiable deletion/destruction.	Yes	Documented retention and secure disposal policy under the ISMS; verifiable deletion certificates provided on request.
5.4.13	Mechanisms to fulfil DSARs, right to erasure and other data-subject rights within legal timeframes.	Yes	Supported — user-level data can be searched, exported and deleted from logs/configuration to support DSAR fulfilment within required timeframes.
5.4.14	DPIAs conducted for high-risk processing activities.	Yes	Alpha Data will support/conduct DPIAs with HCT for high-risk processing (e.g., SSL inspection of user traffic) at design stage.
5.4.15	Prevent unauthorised copying, printing, downloading or exfiltration of classified data via technical controls (DLP, access restrictions).	Yes	Inline-CASB and DLP with content/file-type controls are included in the proposed FortiSASE Advanced tier; RBI read-only mode further prevents exfiltration for BYOD sessions.
5.4.16	Immediate notification of any personal data breach within contractual timeframes.	Yes	Committed — breach notification per HCT contract timeframes through the 24x7 escalation matrix (SOW 3.19/3.22).

6. Section 5.5 — Network & Infrastructure Security

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
5.5.1	Network segmentation/zoning separating production, development and testing; isolation of sensitive components.	Yes	The FortiSASE production tenant is isolated per customer; a separate full-featured sandbox tenant is provided for HCT free of charge for the full term (SOW 3.16.10) so production and test are fully segregated.
5.5.2	Next-generation firewalls with	Yes	FWaaS provides NGFW capability (5,000+

Ref	Requirement	Comply	Remarks / Evidence
	documented, reviewed and approved rule sets.		application signatures, IPS); rule sets are documented, version-controlled and reviewed in the quarterly configuration reviews (SOW 3.18).
5.5.3	Encrypted communications for all data in transit (TLS 1.2+); deprecated protocols disabled.	Yes	TLS 1.2+ enforced end-to-end (agent-to-PoP, IPsec on-ramps, portal); TLS 1.0/1.1 disabled.
5.5.4	IDS/IPS to detect and alert on or block malicious network activity.	Yes	Full IPS is included in the FortiSASE FWaaS stack, powered by FortiGuard Labs threat intelligence, in prevention mode.
5.5.5	All remote access via approved encrypted VPN or ZTNA with MFA enforced.	Yes	Remote/private access is delivered via native ZTNA (optional scope) with per-session posture checks and IdP MFA; no legacy unencrypted remote access is used.
5.5.6a	Maintain and regularly review network architecture documentation, including data flow diagrams.	Yes	As-built architecture and data-flow documentation is a handover deliverable (SOW 3.17.6) and is kept current through change control and quarterly reviews.
5.5.6b	DNS security controls (DNSSEC, DNS filtering) and email security standards (SPF, DKIM, DMARC).	Yes	FortiSASE DNS Security provides DNS filtering with DoH/DoT support; DNSSEC validation supported. Email authentication (SPF/DKIM/DMARC) applies to HCT's mail platform and Alpha Data will validate HCT's existing records as part of hardening.
5.5.7	Prohibit unauthorised wireless access points; enforce WPA3/802.1X on approved wireless networks.	Yes	Campus wireless remains HCT-managed; the solution integrates with HCT NAC/802.1X (SOW 3.9) so only compliant, authenticated devices reach the SASE service, and rogue-AP traffic is not trusted.
5.5.8	DDoS mitigation controls or services protecting availability of internet-facing services.	Yes	Fortinet cloud PoPs include carrier-grade DDoS protection; dual UAE/GCC PoPs each sized at 100% capacity with tested 60-second failover (SOW 3.21.4/3.21.5) protect service availability.

7. Evidence pack

- Fortinet Trust Portal — SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001 and CSA STAR attestations for FortiSASE: <https://trust.fortinet.com/> (downloadable by HCT; full reports under NDA).
- Fortinet ISO 9001:2015 Quality Management certificate (TÜV SÜD, Reg. No. 951 11 5647, valid 1 July 2026 – 30 June 2029) — attached, covering design, development and manufacture of network security products and delivery of associated security services.
- FortiSASE Service Description (Fortinet doc #8702732-2.6) — attached, defining service tiers, 24x7 monitoring, SLA and data-transfer entitlements.
- FortiSASE Administration Guide references cited per checklist row (docs.fortinet.com).

- Alpha Data ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certificate No. AE59507E (Staunchly Management and System Services Ltd, EGAC-accredited, IAF MLA member) — attached; further ISMS policies available upon request.